

Element K

I will be speaking of our process in four sections: Definition and ideation; prototyping; finalizing; reflecting. Definition is exactly what it sounds like: we worked to define the problem. We set constraints, set goals for what we thought we could reasonably accomplish, and set up a decision matrix to decide between different designs. After we had a problem and some guidelines to find our solution, we moved to ideation. This was done separately, with each member of the team doing their own brainstorming. We then just threw each of the possibilities at the decision matrix and saw what stuck. We ended up with a ladder design made of PVC, and we ended up sticking with it throughout the project.

First, we prototyped: we didn't glue any of the pieces together so we could disassemble and reassemble as needed. This allowed us to easily change the length of just one dimension and get the primary stakeholder's feedback on it. This was also the point at which we had outside professionals offer their feedback on the design, resulting in a couple of changes detailed in earlier elements. After we had a working prototype, we began the finishing process, where we did our best to make the handle look and feel like a product instead of just a prototype.

Finally, we began reflection. We went back to our original constraints and goals and saw how they had fared in reality. We gave each a score out of 5, and began the process of preparing for the presentation day.